



The Form Time Quiz: Christmas Edition

A ten-question Christmas quiz played in small teams, with a printed answer sheet for each team. The questions are about Christmas traditions around the world and where they came from: four are fact or myth, then three are multiple choice and three are written answers. Teams swap sheets and mark each other's as the answers go up. It takes about fifteen minutes, and the only printing is one sheet per team.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The answer key for all three quizzes, for you
Page 3	Team answer sheet for Year 7 to 9
Page 4	Team answer sheet for Year 10 and 11
Page 5	Team answer sheet for sixth form

How it works

Step	What happens	Slides
1	Put the form into teams of three or four and give each team the answer sheet for your key stage.	1
2	Read each question out as it goes up. Teams agree an answer and write it on the sheet.	2 to 13
3	Teams swap sheets with the team next to them. Show the answers one at a time and give the room a moment on each one.	14 to 24
4	Sheets go back to their owners, and you find out who got ten.	25

Worth knowing

- Print one sheet per team for the key stage you teach. Each sheet shows the questions as well, so a team that misses one can catch up.
- It works in one go or split in two: round one on a Monday and round two later in the week. It suits the last week of the autumn term.
- The last two slides are blank, for questions of your own, and each answer sheet has two spare rows for them. A question about your own school or something from assembly always goes down well.

More free quizzes and form time activities are on the way. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when they land.





Answer key

All thirty answers in one place, for marking or for settling an argument. The slides carry the same answers, with a line on why for each one.

YEAR 7 TO 9		
1	Fact	In Catalonia, children hit a log with sticks on Christmas Eve until it poos out sweets.
2	Fact	In Japan, fried chicken from KFC is a popular Christmas dinner.
3	Myth	Santa's reindeer, with their big antlers, are probably all boys.
4	Myth	Hiding a glass pickle in the Christmas tree is an old German tradition.
5	B, Summer	In Australia, which season is it at Christmas?
6	B, A witch on a broomstick	In Italy, who fills children's stockings on the night of 5 January?
7	C, Red crabs	Every year on Christmas Island, millions of which animal march to the sea?
8	An apple	In China, which fruit is a popular present on Christmas Eve?
9	Canada	Which country gives Santa his own postcode, HOH OH0?
10	The Netherlands	In which country does Sinterklaas arrive every November on a steamboat from Spain?
YEAR 10 AND 11		
1	Myth	Coca-Cola invented the red Santa suit.
2	Myth	Writing "Xmas" is a modern way of taking Christ out of Christmas.
3	Fact	A giant straw goat built every Christmas in Gävle, Sweden, has been destroyed more often than it has survived.
4	Fact	In the Czech Republic, some families keep their Christmas dinner alive in the bath.
5	B, 7 January	When does Ethiopia celebrate Christmas?
6	C, On roller skates	In Caracas, Venezuela, how did many people traditionally travel to early morning Christmas church services?
7	B, Mexico	The poinsettia, the red Christmas plant, first grew wild in which country?
8	Ukraine	"Carol of the Bells" started as a song from which country?
9	An unexpected guest	In Poland, families set an extra place at the Christmas Eve table. Who is it for?
10	Flood	Iceland's tradition of giving books on Christmas Eve is called the Christmas Book... what?
SIXTH FORM		
1	Myth	Thanks to Oliver Cromwell, it is still illegal to eat a mince pie on Christmas Day in England.
2	Myth	Martin Luther invented the Christmas tree.
3	Fact	Armenian Christians in Jerusalem celebrate Christmas on 19 January.
4	Fact	The first Christmas card, printed in 1843, caused a row because it showed a child drinking wine.
5	B, A tenth to a third	An economist found that people value the presents they get at less than they cost. Roughly how much of the value is lost?
6	C, 28	How many candles were on the first Advent wreath, in 1839?
7	B, AD 354	The oldest known record of Christmas on 25 December comes from which year?
8	Ukraine	In 2023, which country moved its official Christmas Day from 7 January to 25 December?
9	Birth	The French word "Noël" comes from a Latin word meaning what?
10	The Julian calendar	Many Orthodox churches celebrate Christmas on 7 January. Which calendar are they following?





Team answer sheet

Agree each answer as a team, then tick a box or write it in. When the answers go up, swap sheets with the team next to you and mark theirs in the dashed boxes.

TEAM NAME

MARKED BY

MARK

ROUND ONE Fact or myth

- | | | | | |
|---|---|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1 | In Catalonia, children hit a log with sticks on Christmas Eve until it poos out sweets. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |
| 2 | In Japan, fried chicken from KFC is a popular Christmas dinner. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |
| 3 | Santa's reindeer, with their big antlers, are probably all boys. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |
| 4 | Hiding a glass pickle in the Christmas tree is an old German tradition. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |

ROUND TWO Choose or write

- | | | | | | |
|----|--|----------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| 5 | In Australia, which season is it at Christmas? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | ☐ |
| 6 | In Italy, who fills children's stockings on the night of 5 January? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | ☐ |
| 7 | Every year on Christmas Island, millions of which animal march to the sea? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | ☐ |
| 8 | In China, which fruit is a popular present on Christmas Eve? | <input type="text"/> | | | ☐ |
| 9 | Which country gives Santa his own postcode, H0H 0H0? | <input type="text"/> | | | ☐ |
| 10 | In which country does Sinterklaas arrive every November on a steamboat from Spain? | <input type="text"/> | | | ☐ |

EXTRA Your teacher's own questions, if there are any

- | | | | |
|----|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|
| 11 | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | ☐ |
| 12 | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | ☐ |

SCORE

/ 10

One mark for each right answer. If your teacher added questions of their own, count those too and change the ten.





Team answer sheet

Agree each answer as a team, then tick a box or write it in. When the answers go up, swap sheets with the team next to you and mark theirs in the dashed boxes.

TEAM NAME

MARKED BY

MARK

ROUND ONE Fact or myth

- | | | | | |
|---|--|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--|
| 1 | Coca-Cola invented the red Santa suit. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | |
| 2 | Writing "Xmas" is a modern way of taking Christ out of Christmas. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | |
| 3 | A giant straw goat built every Christmas in Gävle, Sweden, has been destroyed more often than it has survived. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | |
| 4 | In the Czech Republic, some families keep their Christmas dinner alive in the bath. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | |

ROUND TWO Choose or write

- | | | | | | |
|----|---|---|----------------------------|----------------------------|--|
| 5 | When does Ethiopia celebrate Christmas? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | |
| 6 | In Caracas, Venezuela, how did many people traditionally travel to early morning Christmas church services? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | |
| 7 | The poinsettia, the red Christmas plant, first grew wild in which country? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | |
| 8 | "Carol of the Bells" started as a song from which country? | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | | | |
| 9 | In Poland, families set an extra place at the Christmas Eve table. Who is it for? | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | | | |
| 10 | Iceland's tradition of giving books on Christmas Eve is called the Christmas Book... what? | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | | | |

EXTRA Your teacher's own questions, if there are any

- | | | | |
|----|---|---|--|
| 11 | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | |
| 12 | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | <input style="width: 100%;" type="text"/> | |

SCORE / 10

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Team answer sheet

Agree each answer as a team, then tick a box or write it in. When the answers go up, swap sheets with the team next to you and mark theirs in the dashed boxes.

TEAM NAME

MARKED BY

MARK

ROUND ONE Fact or myth

- | | | | | |
|---|--|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1 | Thanks to Oliver Cromwell, it is still illegal to eat a mince pie on Christmas Day in England. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |
| 2 | Martin Luther invented the Christmas tree. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |
| 3 | Armenian Christians in Jerusalem celebrate Christmas on 19 January. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |
| 4 | The first Christmas card, printed in 1843, caused a row because it showed a child drinking wine. | ☐ Fact | ☐ Myth | ☐ |

ROUND TWO Choose or write

- | | | | | | |
|----|---|----------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| 5 | An economist found that people value the presents they get at less than they cost. Roughly how much of the value is lost? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | ☐ |
| 6 | How many candles were on the first Advent wreath, in 1839? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | ☐ |
| 7 | The oldest known record of Christmas on 25 December comes from which year? | ☐ A | ☐ B | ☐ C | ☐ |
| 8 | In 2023, which country moved its official Christmas Day from 7 January to 25 December? | <input type="text"/> | | | ☐ |
| 9 | The French word "Noël" comes from a Latin word meaning what? | <input type="text"/> | | | ☐ |
| 10 | Many Orthodox churches celebrate Christmas on 7 January. Which calendar are they following? | <input type="text"/> | | | ☐ |

EXTRA Your teacher's own questions, if there are any

- | | | | |
|----|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|
| 11 | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | ☐ |
| 12 | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | ☐ |

SCORE

/ 10

One mark for each right answer. If your teacher added questions of their own, count those too and change the ten.

